

The Wedding Reception Photo Timeline

A simple guide to placing your photo booth at the right moment, so it adds to the night instead of competing with it.

GUEST LIST - LUXURY PHOTO BOOTH RENTALS.

BEFORE YOU BUILD IT

Start with your send-off time

Most couples build their timeline forward from the ceremony. For your photo booth, it works better to count backward from the moment your reception ends. Confirm that time with your venue or coordinator first, then slot the booth into the hours that actually have guests on the floor: cocktail hour and the stretch after dinner, not the ceremony itself.

PACKAGE	LENGTH	BEST FOR
The Social	2 hours	Cocktail hour through the start of dancing
The Signature	3 hours	Cocktail hour straight through to the open dance floor
The Celebration	4 hours	Cocktail hour all the way to a late send-off

Not sure which length fits your reception? Add up cocktail hour plus the time between your last course and your planned exit. That total is your booth window.

THE TIMELINE

Hour by hour

COCKTAIL HOUR

Open the booth as soon as guests arrive.

This is the easiest window of the night: everyone is dressed up, nobody is seated yet, and there is no program to interrupt. It is also usually the lightest crowd moment, so lines stay short and your host has time to walk first-time guests through the booth.

BOOTH NOTE

Place the booth near the bar or entrance, not tucked in a back corner. People try it because they walk past it.

GRAND ENTRANCE & FIRST DANCE

Let the booth go quiet.

This is the couple's moment, not the booth's. Most hosts pause here, or at least expect a natural lull, while everyone's attention is on the dance floor.

BOOTH NOTE

No action needed. A good host reads the room and does not need reminding to pause.

THE TIMELINE, CONTINUED

Where the booth earns its keep

DINNER & TOASTS

Treat this as a built-in break.

Seated guests rarely leave the table for a photo booth. This window usually becomes a quiet stretch for your host to restock props and reset the backdrop before the floor opens back up.

BOOTH NOTE

If your reception runs long, ask your host for a short break here rather than cutting time from the open floor later.

CAKE CUTTING

A short, optional pause.

Some couples like a quick break here for photos of the cake moment itself; others fold it straight into the open floor. Either way, this is a five-minute decision.

BOOTH NOTE

Tell your host in advance if you want the booth to pause here, so nobody is mid-pose when the room goes quiet for the cake.

LAST STOP

Close it out gracefully

OPEN DANCE FLOOR

This is peak booth time.

Once dinner wraps and the floor opens, this is where a photo booth does its real work: guests are relaxed and the energy is highest. If your package covers only part of the night, this is the window to protect.

BOOTH NOTE

Ask your DJ to announce the booth as the floor opens. A single mention sends guests over in the first ten minutes.

LATE NIGHT & SEND-OFF

Plan your last call.

Set a clear closing time for the booth, ideally 20 to 30 minutes before your actual send-off, so your host can break down calmly instead of rushing during your final moments.

BOOTH NOTE

For a final keepsake, ask your host to save a template slot for a closing group shot before the booth powers down.

Every Guest List package includes delivery, setup, breakdown, and a dedicated on-site host who reads the room for you, so none of this has to be managed on the day itself.



WHY HOSTS CHOOSE US

Guest List vs. A Typical Photo Booth Rental

	GUEST LIST	TYPICAL RENTAL
Dedicated on-site host	Included with every package	Often self-serve, or an add-on fee
Photo backdrop	Premium, curated selection	Basic, or not included
GIFs & boomerangs	Included	Frequently an extra charge
Event template design	Custom-designed for your day	Generic, stock template
Sharing your photos	Instant, by text, email, or QR code	Download link only, if offered
Gallery delivery	Private online gallery, same night	Days later, if delivered at all
Checking a date	Free date check, no payment required	Deposit often requested just to inquire
Booth style	Sleek digital iPad setup	Bulky traditional enclosed booth

LET'S MAKE IT OFFICIAL

Ready to check your date?

A complimentary date check takes a minute, and no payment is required to ask.

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